India's diplomatic rebound, however, was met with a setback when a secret document titled 'Roadmap to Peace 2015' was leaked in December 2012. Drafted sometime in early 2012, the document said that by 2015, the Taliban, the Hizb-e-Islami and other armed groups will have 'given up armed opposition, transformed from military entities into political groups, and are actively participating in the country's political and constitutional processes, including national elections'.[113] For this to happen, however, it was imperative that Pakistan facilitated 'direct contact between the HPC/Government of Afghanistan and identified leaders of the Taliban and other armed opposition groups' through Salahuddin Rabbani, Burhanuddin's son who had taken over as the chief of the HPC.[114] Giving space to almost every armed group including the Haqqani network, the roadmap was received with disdain by India. What worried India more than the document itself was the fact that it had come from Karzai's palace, and had been drafted by none other than Jawed Ludin, Afghanistan's charismatic deputy foreign minister, and a good friend of Mukhopadhaya. The document belied efforts New Delhi had made in the recent months to keep Pakistan from setting the terms of reconciliation. Drafted sometime in early 2012, practical implementation of the roadmap's recommendation required sustained US military presence in Afghanistan after 2015. Even if different factions in Kabul would have accepted the roadmap, continued US military presence was a no-go, especially for the conservative section of Karzai's palace officials. Karzai's chief of staff, Karim Khurram, for instance, bitterly opposed a bilateral security agreement with the US.[115] The roadmap was leaked amidst a series of failed talks between Kabul and the Taliban in Qatar, Islamabad, Chantilly, and Ashgabad.

Shocked, Mukhopadhaya personally informed Karzai, Ludin, and Rabbani that he didn't think they knew what they were doing with the roadmap to peace.[116] He asserted that Kabul's faith in Pakistan was misplaced and Islamabad would surely sabotage the peace process. Arguing that India was averse to what it called the 'Western model' of reconciliation (however straightjacketed and under-appreciative this term is about the complexity of the ongoing dialogue), Mukhopadhaya tried to push for a return to the 'Afghan model' of reconciliation. The basic idea of the 'Afghan Model' was to get the Taliban 'out of the clutches' of the ISI.[117] This was to be done by bringing Taliban figures to a third country